SnowyKim

Executive Workforce Strategy FY2027

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This document contains workforce planning assumptions, budget scenarios, succession considerations, retention risks, and potential organizational actions that have not been announced. Unauthorized disclosure may materially harm employees, candidates, and SnowyKim.

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1. Executive Summary

SnowyKim enters FY2027 with strong product demand, improving enterprise retention, and growing pressure on engineering, data, customer success, and HR operations. The primary workforce objective is controlled growth: invest in roles directly tied to product delivery and recurring revenue while holding support-function growth below the prior-year rate. The strategy assumes continued expansion in San Francisco and New York, with no third office planned during FY2027.

The base plan increases total headcount from 20 to 34 employees by fiscal year-end. Hiring will be staged rather than front-loaded. Eight roles are planned for the first half of the year, and six are contingent on revenue milestones, product launch stability, and voluntary attrition. Executives should avoid describing the contingent roles as approved openings until the Chief Financial Officer and Chief Executive Officer release the relevant requisitions.

FY2027 Workforce Priorities

- Protect delivery capacity in Engineering, Data, Product, and HRIS.
- Build a small enterprise customer success function before expanding general sales capacity.
- Reduce single-person dependencies in finance operations, HR operations, security administration, and production data pipelines.
- Improve manager quality through clearer spans, structured calibration, and executive succession reviews.
- Keep fixed labor cost within the approved operating envelope while preserving selective retention flexibility.

Key Executive Decisions Required

Decision	Target Date	Decision Owner
Approve Phase 1 headcount release	August 15, 2026	CEO / CFO
Confirm enterprise customer success leadership model	September 2026	CEO / CRO
Select Data leadership successor and development plan	October 2026	CEO / CPO
Approve compensation pool and critical retention reserve	November 2026	Comp Committee
Confirm Phase 2 hiring based on revenue and launch metrics	January 2027	Executive Team

2. Headcount Plan and Hiring Sequence

The headcount plan is designed around constrained sequencing. Recruiting must prioritize roles that remove immediate execution bottlenecks, followed by roles that improve scale and resilience. Opening all roles simultaneously would exceed recruiting capacity, weaken interview quality, and create avoidable onboarding congestion.

Function	Current	FY2027 Target	Net Change	Priority
Engineering	3	7	+4	Critical
Data	3	5	+2	High
Product	2	4	+2	High
Marketing	2	3	+1	Medium
Sales / Customer Success	2	5	+3	High
Finance	2	2	0	Hold
HR / HRIS	4	5	+1	High
IT / Security	1	2	+1	Critical
Executive / Operations	1	1	0	Hold

Phase 1: Approved Planning Assumption

Phase 1 hiring is expected to begin in Q3 FY2026 for start dates spanning Q4 FY2026 through Q1 FY2027. Requisitions remain confidential until opened in the applicant tracking system.

- Two software engineers focused on platform reliability and enterprise integrations.
- One applied machine learning engineer focused on model adaptation, evaluation, and inference efficiency.
- One data engineer to reduce production pipeline risk and improve analytics freshness.
- One product manager focused on enterprise workflows and administrative controls.
- One enterprise customer success manager.
- One security engineer or senior IT security specialist.
- One HR operations specialist with onboarding, leave, and employee support ownership.

Phase 2: Contingent Roles

Phase 2 roles should open only if the company reaches the approved revenue threshold, the enterprise launch remains within service targets, and annualized voluntary attrition remains below 18 percent. The contingent set currently includes a second customer success manager, a solutions engineer, an additional software engineer, a product designer, a lifecycle marketing manager, and a people analytics specialist.

3. Organization Design Scenarios

The executive team is evaluating two organization designs for the second half of FY2027. Neither option has been communicated to managers. Until a decision is made, leaders should avoid creating expectations about promotions, reporting changes, or new leadership positions.

Scenario A: Functional Scale

Under Scenario A, current functional leaders retain ownership as teams grow. Engineering, Data, Product, Marketing, Sales, Finance, HR, and IT remain distinct. This model minimizes disruption and is appropriate if headcount growth remains near the base plan. The principal risk is continued executive involvement in routine cross-functional decisions.

Scenario B: Product and Enterprise Operating Groups

Under Scenario B, SnowyKim would create two operating groups: Product Platform and Enterprise Delivery. Engineering, Data, and Product employees would be aligned to one of the groups while retaining functional career management. This model could accelerate accountability for enterprise outcomes but would require stronger group leadership and more mature planning processes.

Factor	Scenario A	Scenario B
Near-term disruption	Low	Moderate
Cross-functional accountability	Moderate	High
Leadership depth required	Current level	Additional leaders needed
Best fit	Base growth plan	Upside growth plan
Primary risk	Executive bottlenecks	Matrix confusion

Potential Reporting Changes Under Review

- Moving HRIS ownership directly under the Chief People Officer while maintaining a dotted-line relationship with IT.
- Creating a Head of Enterprise Delivery role if enterprise recurring revenue reaches the approved threshold.
- Separating customer success from new-logo sales once the customer base reaches the planned account count.
- Adding a formal Data leadership layer if the current director span expands beyond the agreed limit.

4. Retention Risk and Critical Talent

Retention analysis indicates that overall engagement remains acceptable, but the company has several concentrated risks. The greatest exposure is not broad dissatisfaction; it is the possibility of losing one or two employees who hold unique technical, customer, or operational knowledge. Executives should avoid discussing named retention risks outside the leadership team.

Risk Area	Risk Level	Primary Concern	Planned Response
Data leadership	High	Single-point ownership of production analytics and model evaluation	Succession plan plus selective retention action
HRIS	High	Small team and growing workflow demand	Add HR operations capacity; document systems
Platform engineering	High	Enterprise integration knowledge concentrated in two employees	Hire two engineers; establish runbooks
Enterprise sales	Medium-High	Relationship continuity during account growth	Add customer success capacity
Finance operations	Medium	Limited backup for close and planning processes	Cross-train; defer headcount unless risk increases

Critical Retention Reserve

The compensation plan includes a limited executive-controlled retention reserve. The reserve may be used for exceptional base adjustments, retention bonuses, or equity refreshes where there is documented business risk. It is not intended to correct broad market positioning or replace normal promotion decisions. Proposed awards require CEO, CFO, and Chief People Officer approval.

Do Not Signal Prematurely

Executives should not suggest to employees that they have been identified as a retention risk, succession candidate, or likely recipient of a special award. Premature signals create expectations, undermine calibration, and may be interpreted as commitments.

5. Leadership Succession and Readiness

Succession planning is intended to reduce operational risk and create credible internal growth paths. Readiness labels are planning tools, not promises. The executive team will review succession coverage twice during FY2027 and after any unexpected leadership departure.

Leadership Area	Coverage	Readiness Assessment	FY2027 Action
Engineering	Partial	Internal technical depth; limited people leadership bench	Assign deputy responsibilities and coaching
Data	Weak	One plausible successor requires broader stakeholder exposure	Create six-month development plan
Product	Partial	Strong execution talent; no immediate full-scope successor	Expand roadmap and customer exposure
Sales / Enterprise	Weak	External hire likely if scale accelerates	Begin market mapping
Finance	Adequate	Operational continuity available	Document planning cadence
People / HRIS	Partial	HR operations depth improving; executive succession not immediate	Cross-train HRIS and employee relations

Executive Development Priorities

- Delegate recurring operational decisions to reduce executive dependency.
- Require each executive to identify one emergency backup and one developmental successor.
- Increase exposure of high-potential leaders to customer, budget, and workforce tradeoffs.
- Use interim assignments before creating permanent director or vice president roles.

6. Compensation and Promotion Planning

The FY2027 planning assumption includes a 4.0 percent company-wide merit budget, a separate promotion pool, and a limited market adjustment pool. Final budgets are subject to compensation committee approval. Managers must not receive budget guidance until the formal compensation cycle begins.

Component	Planning Assumption	Executive Guidance
Merit budget	4.0% of eligible payroll	Differentiate based on performance and market position
Promotion pool	1.5% of eligible payroll	Use for sustained next-level scope, not retention alone
Market adjustment pool	0.8% of eligible payroll	Prioritize documented external gaps
Retention reserve	Discretionary, limited	CEO/CFO/CPO approval required
Equity refresh	Selective	Prioritize critical and high-impact roles

Promotion Controls

The executive team should resist title inflation as a substitute for role clarity or compensation. Promotions should require sustained performance at the next level, an ongoing business need for the larger scope, and consistent calibration across functions. Backdated promotions and off-cycle title changes should be rare and require Chief People Officer approval.

Pay Transparency Risk

Compensation communications must distinguish between salary range, individual pay decision, bonus target, and equity eligibility. Executives should not disclose another employee's compensation or suggest that a range guarantees a particular offer or adjustment.

7. Workforce Reduction and Cost Contingency

No reduction in force is approved or planned under the base operating plan. However, the executive team has defined contingency triggers to ensure that cost action is deliberate rather than reactive. This section is scenario planning only and must not be interpreted as an announced or probable action.

Contingency Triggers

- Two consecutive quarters materially below the approved recurring revenue plan.
- Enterprise launch delays that require a revised funding or operating plan.
- A sustained cash runway forecast below the executive minimum.
- Unexpected legal, security, or infrastructure costs that cannot be absorbed through discretionary reductions.

Order of Operations

Step	Potential Action
1	Freeze noncritical contingent hiring and contractor expansion
2	Reduce discretionary travel, events, external consulting, and nonessential software
3	Delay backfills and selected Phase 2 roles
4	Review scope consolidation and management layers
5	Consider targeted workforce actions only after legal and financial review

Executives must not use phrases such as “layoffs are coming,” “your role is safe,” or “this team will be cut” without an approved communication plan. Even informal comments may spread quickly and create avoidable harm.

8. AI and Automation Workforce Strategy

SnowyKim plans to increase responsible use of AI in engineering, customer support, analytics, recruiting operations, and internal knowledge workflows. The workforce strategy is augmentation-first: use automation to remove repetitive work, improve quality, and increase capacity before considering role elimination.

Priority Investment Areas

- Internal HR assistant with role-based retrieval, auditability, and employee self-service.
- Developer support for code navigation, testing, documentation, and incident analysis.
- Customer support summarization and recommended next actions with human review.
- Analytics workflow acceleration, including data quality checks and narrative reporting.
- Recruiting operations support for scheduling, interview packet preparation, and policy-compliant communication.

Workforce Implications

The company expects job content to change more quickly than job count in FY2027. Teams should update role expectations, training plans, and quality controls before reducing staffing assumptions. Any proposal to remove a role primarily because of AI must include evidence of sustained workload reduction, control readiness, service impact, and redeployment options.

Executive AI Governance

- Sensitive employee, compensation, investigation, or succession information must not enter unapproved models.
- Human decision-makers remain accountable for employment, promotion, pay, and disciplinary decisions.
- Material model failures must be logged, reviewed, and incorporated into release criteria.

9. Executive Workforce Dashboard

The executive dashboard will be reviewed monthly. Metrics are intended to support decisions, not to replace judgment. Small-team percentages can be volatile and should be interpreted with underlying counts and qualitative context.

Metric	FY2027 Target / Guardrail
Total headcount	34 or fewer under base plan
Voluntary attrition	Below 18% annualized
Critical-role vacancy time	Below 75 days
Offer acceptance	At least 75%
New-hire 90-day retention	At least 95%
Manager span	Generally 4-8 direct reports when applicable
Internal fill rate	At least 20% of eligible leadership and specialist roles
Regrettable attrition	No more than 2 critical departures

Communication Protocol

Workforce information should be communicated according to decision status. Planning assumptions remain within the executive team. Approved requisitions may be shared with hiring managers and recruiters. Final organization changes require coordinated messages, manager guidance, employee FAQs, and timing plans.

Status	Permitted Description
Planning only	Do not communicate outside executive team
Approved but not announced	Share only with implementation owners
Manager pre-brief	Confidential until employee communication
Employee announcement	Use approved language and FAQs
Public information	May be discussed externally if authorized

10. FY2027 Executive Action Plan

Timing	Action	Accountable Executive
July-August 2026	Finalize Phase 1 sequencing and recruiting capacity	CPO / CFO
September 2026	Review enterprise delivery structure and customer success model	CEO / CRO
October 2026	Complete succession and critical-role risk review	CPO / Executive Team
November 2026	Approve compensation, promotion, and retention pools	Comp Committee
December 2026	Assess launch readiness and contingent hiring triggers	CTO / CPO / CFO
January 2027	Release, defer, or cancel Phase 2 roles	Executive Team
Quarterly	Review headcount, attrition, recruiting, and manager capacity	Executive Team

Required Executive Behaviors

- Use consistent workforce assumptions in budget, hiring, and team communications.
- Do not make individual employment commitments before approvals are complete.
- Escalate retention risk early, with evidence and a proposed response.
- Protect confidential succession, compensation, and contingency information.
- Document decisions, owners, dates, and dependencies after each workforce review.

Document Control

This document will be reviewed quarterly by the Chief People Officer and updated when workforce assumptions materially change. Superseded versions must be removed from shared executive repositories. Printed copies should be destroyed securely.

Demonstration disclaimer: SnowyKim, its workforce plans, people, addresses, email accounts, financial assumptions, and business scenarios are fictional and created for an HR chatbot and role-based access control demonstration.